

NAVIGATOR KIDS: VOLCANO NAVIGATOR

A Field Guide for Managing Big Energy

WARNING: This book belongs to a Dragon Trainer!

Navigator Name: _____

Date Mission Began: _____

IDENTIFY YOUR DRAGON TYPE:

(Check all that apply to your Super Brain)

☐ **The Fire Breather:** I have big, fast energy.

☐ **The Deep Feeler:** When I am sad or happy, I feel it *very* much.

☐ **The Sensor:** Loud noises or scratchy clothes bother my dragon scales.

☐ **The Protector:** I care a lot about fairness and rules.

CURRENT STATUS:

You are not "bad" for having big feelings. You just have a very powerful engine inside you. This book will teach you how to steer it.

Are you ready to cool down the lava?

☐ YES ☐ ROAR!

Page 2: The Story – The Volcano Inside

Meet Ember.

Ember is a Dragon with a heart of gold and a belly full of fire. Most of the time, Ember's fire is useful. It helps him fly fast, roast marshmallows, and keep his friends warm.

But sometimes, the fire gets **TOO BIG**.

When things go wrong—like when his tower falls over or he has to stop playing—Ember's tummy rumbles. His face gets hot. The smoke starts to rise.

It feels like a VOLCANO is about to explode!

When the volcano blows, Ember roars loud and stomps his feet. He doesn't mean to be scary; he just has too much hot lava inside and nowhere to put it.

YOUR TURN:

Draw what your "Volcano" looks like when it explodes. Is it messy? Loud? Red?

Page 3: Super Tool #1 – Body Clues

THE MISSION:

A volcano doesn't just explode out of nowhere. The ground shakes first! Your body gives you "clues" that the lava is rising. If we catch the clues early, we can stop the explosion.

Activity: Map Your Magma

Look at the kid below. Where do YOU feel big feelings? Color in the spots that get hot or tight.

Circle the Clues you feel:

1. **The Head:** Does your face get hot and red?
2. **The Throat:** Does your voice get loud or raspy?
3. **The Heart:** Does it beat fast? *Thump-thump-thump!*
4. **The Tummy:** Do you feel butterflies or a knot?
5. **The Hands:** Do they make tight fists?
6. **The Feet:** Do they want to kick or stomp?

My #1 Clue is: _____

When I feel this clue, I know it is time to use a Tool!

Page 4: Super Tool #2 – Dragon Breath

THE MISSION:

Fire needs air to burn. But if we control the air, we can cool the fire down. We call this **Dragon Breath**.

Activity: The Infinity Loop

Use your finger to trace the figure-8 shape below. Do not lift your finger!

Follow the instructions as you trace:

LEFT LOOP (Go Up):



Smell the Flower

Breathe IN through your nose for 4 seconds.

(Sniff... 1... 2... 3... 4)

CENTER:

Hold it for 1 second.

RIGHT LOOP (Go Down):



Blow out the Candle

Breathe OUT through your mouth for 4 seconds.

(Whoosh... 1... 2... 3... 4)

Repeat 5 times.

Color in one flame for every breath you take:



Page 5: Super Tool #3 – The Lemon Squeeze

THE MISSION:

When we get angry or anxious, our muscles turn into hard rocks. To make them soft again, we have to squeeze all the "juice" out first!

Activity: Make Lemonade

Step 1: The Squeeze

Pretend you have a sour lemon in each hand.

Squeeze your fists as TIGHT as you can!

Tighten your arms! Hunch your shoulders up to your ears!

Scrunch your face up!

Hold it... Hold it... (Count to 5)

Step 2: The Drop

Drop the lemons! Let your hands go floppy like cooked spaghetti.

Shake them out. *Wiggle, wiggle, wiggle.*

Check-in:

How do your hands feel now?

☐ Still hard like rocks

☐ Soft and warm

☐ Tingly

Repeat until all the juice is gone!

Page 6: The Science – Your Dragon Brain

Why does the Volcano blow?

Inside your brain, there are two main characters:

1. The Guard Dragon (Amygdala)

This part of your brain looks for danger. It is fast and loud. When it sees something scary or frustrating, it pulls the "Fire Alarm" to keep you safe.

2. The Wise Owl (Prefrontal Cortex)

This part of your brain thinks, plans, and uses words.

The Glitch:

When the Guard Dragon gets too hot, it fills the room with smoke. The Wise Owl can't see, so it flies away! That is why you can't "use your words" when you are melting down.

How to fix it:

We use our tools (Breathing and Squeezing) to clear the smoke. When the smoke clears, the Wise Owl can come back and help you solve the problem.

Page 7: Scenario Challenge

Situation:

Ember is building a super tall Lego tower. He is almost done! Suddenly, his tail knocks it over. *CRASH!*

His face gets hot. His fists ball up. The Guard Dragon is reaching for the alarm!

What should Ember do?

Option A: Scream and throw the Legos across the room.

Option B: Push the feelings down and pretend he doesn't care.

Option C: Use the Navigator Tools.

Let's help Ember use Option C!

1. **Body Clue:** Ember notices his fists are tight.
2. **Tool Choice:** He chooses **Lemon Squeeze**.
 - *Squeeze... and drop.*
3. **Result:** His hands feel floppy. The Guard Dragon calms down. The Wise Owl comes back and says: *"We can build it again, maybe even stronger."*

Your Turn:

Draw a star next to the tool YOU would use if your toy broke:

() Dragon Breath

() Lemon Squeeze

() Safe Spot (Go to my room)

Page 8: Parent & Co-Pilot Guide

The Science of Emotional Regulation

For neurodivergent children (2e/ADHD/ASD), emotions are often experienced at a higher intensity. This is not a behavior problem; it is a biology reality.

1. Interoception (The Body Clues):

Many neurodivergent kids struggle to feel their body's signals until they are already at a "10." The goal of this workbook is to help them recognize a "3" (warm face) so they can intervene before the explosion.

2. Co-Regulation:

A child in a meltdown cannot calm themselves down. Their "Wise Owl" has left the building. They need you to lend them your calm.

- *Don't:* Ask questions or lecture ("Why did you do that?").
- *Do:* Model the breathing. Sit near them. Limit words.

3. Progressive Muscle Relaxation (Lemon Squeeze):

Anxiety stores physical tension in the body. Squeezing and releasing manually "resets" the nervous system from Fight/Flight to Rest/Digest.

Quick Script for Parents:

- Instead of: "Calm down!"
- Try: "I see your fire is getting big. Let's blow out some candles together."

Page 9: Pocket Cards & Safe Spot Pass

(Cut these out and keep them in your pocket!)

| 🔍 **BODY CLUES** | 🐉 **DRAGON BREATH** | | | | Check
your dashboard:

1. Smell the flower. - Is my face hot? (Inhale nose 4 sec) - Is my heart fast?	2. Hold for 1 sec. - Are my hands tight?
3. Blow the candle. <i>I can catch it early!</i> (Exhale mouth 4 sec)	

MASTER VOLCANO NAVIGATOR

This certifies that

Has learned to listen to their body and cool down the fire.

You have mastered:

The Body Scan 🔍

The Dragon Breath 🐉

The Lemon Squeeze 🍋

Remember: Your fire makes you powerful. Your tools make you wise.

Signed: _____ (Head Dragon Trainer)

Date: _____